

Postmortem INC-7750: cart-api thread pool starvation

Date: May 2026. Duration: 56 minutes. Severity: SEV2.

Summary

Customers saw errors from cart-api for 56 minutes. The trigger was thread pool starvation.

Timeline

09:12 alert fired. 09:20 incident declared. 09:35 mitigation applied.

Root cause

A change merged two days earlier removed a safety limit, so thread pool starvation was able to build up unnoticed until peak traffic. Monitoring did not alert early because the threshold was set for the old traffic pattern.

Contributing factors

- The runbook pointed to a dashboard that had been renamed.
- The canary stage was skipped for a config-only change.

Action items

- AI-275: restore the safety limit and add a regression test.
- AI-646: update the alert threshold to the new traffic pattern.
- AI-846: never skip the canary, including for config changes.